

Post-Op Instructions: Extractions

It is normal to experience some discomfort as well as minor bleeding and "oozing" for several days after an extraction.

Call right away if you have these symptoms

- Heavy or increased bleeding
- Pain or swelling that increases or continues beyond three days
- Bad taste or odor in your mouth
- Reaction to the medication

Call (225) 925-2118. For emergencies, including difficulty breathing, call 911 or go to your nearest emergency department.

It is important that a blood clot forms on the extraction site to stop bleeding, reduce pain, and speed healing. To protect the clot and avoid the pain of a dry socket, do the following.

First 24 Hours

- Bite on gauze firmly, changing it out as it becomes saturated, until bleeding stops and gauze is a very light pink color. Blood and saliva mixed in the mouth may make it seem like there is more bleeding than there really is. The site could ooze for as long as 24 hours.
- Take medication before anesthetic has worn off or as recommended.
- To control swelling, use an ice bag over the area, 20 minutes on and 20 minutes off.
- Do NOT spit, suck candy or suck through a straw, or rinse. If rinsing is needed, allow water to flow around the mouth and let it fall out. Do NOT gargle and spit.
- Do NOT brush or floss next to the site.
- Do NOT smoke or use tobacco for at least 72 hours because it slows healing.
- Try not to sneeze or cough, so make sure you have sinus allergy medication on hand.
- Limit yourself to calm activities.
- Elevate your head with pillows when you lie down to reduce bleeding.
- Do NOT drink hot, carbonated, or alcoholic drinks.
- Avoid hot or spicy foods.
- When numbness has worn off completely, drink lots of fluids and eat only soft nutritious foods, being careful to chew on the opposite side.

After First 24 Hours

- If prescribed, continue taking antibiotics as instructed even if all symptoms are gone.

- Begin to eat normally as soon as it is comfortable.
- Resume regular brushing and flossing, but be gentle around the site for about a week.
- Reduce soreness or swelling by applying moist heat. Usually, swelling goes down after 48 hours.
- Rinse gently with warm salt water, one teaspoon salt per glass of warm water, 2 to 3 times a day for a week after the extraction.
- It could possibly take 7 to 12 weeks for the site to fully heal.
- You will receive a two week post-operative appointment before leaving the office. If you have any questions or concerns before then, please call the office.

Questions or concerns, call (225) 925-2118. After hours or on weekends, leave a message and someone will return your call shortly. For a medical emergency, including difficulty breathing, call 911 or go to your nearest emergency department.

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